The Six Heart Mantras of the Perfections

Toh 936 · Derge Kangyur

This short Kangyur work, which might be called in English something like The Heart Mantras of the Perfections, opens with homage to the Three Jewels and then sets out a series of brief Sanskrit mantras, each linked to one of the perfections, the core virtues cultivated on the bodhisattva path. Each mantra is introduced with the promise that hearing it just once brings the quality it embodies, beginning with generosity and continuing through moral discipline, patience, and diligence, and presumably on to the remaining perfections. Its source title lines do not give a distinct Sanskrit or Tibetan title, so the work is best identified by its content: an invocation that pairs devotion to awakened beings with the aspiration to embody these virtues. It is Toh 936 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī and mantra texts, compact ritual formulas valued for the blessing and protection they are believed to confer through recitation and hearing.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

By hearing this heart mantra of generosity just once, one will attain generosity.
oṃ namastvai bhagavati dānādhipataye svāhā

By hearing this heart mantra of moral discipline just once, one will attain moral discipline.
namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ mahākanādamakānāṃ namo bhagavatyai śīlaparipūrṇaśarīyai śīlaṃ me sādhaya sādhaya kinatiṣṭa saṃbuṃddho bhagavana dharmasya samājñānāpayati svāhā

By hearing this heart mantra of patience just once, one will attain patience.
namaḥ sarva tathāgatāya acinta gocarya namo kṣānatiyai bahubhiḥ tthāgatanabhutakoṭibhivarivaratitayai rakṣa kuru turu turu samaya manusmara śākyamuni sarva tathāgatānāṃ aparimitā jñāna gocaro jñānāpayati svāhā

By hearing this heart mantra of diligence just once, one will attain diligence.
namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ macinatya viśāyanā namastute bhagavate vīryapāramitā vīryana kuru vīrye vīrye mahāvīrya tathāgata sarva jñānāpayati svāhā

By hearing this heart mantra of meditative concentration just once, one will attain meditative concentration.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ oṃ vimale niramale dhyāne dhyāne dhyānapriye hūṃ phaṭ

By hearing this heart mantra of wisdom just once, one will attain wisdom.
namaḥ sarva tathāgatāya aparimita jñāna gocarāya namo bhagavate jñāna pāramitāyai jñānāṃ ne kuru kuru vigāna tathāgatasya samaya manusmara hi hi hi jñā jñā jñā jñā hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Here ends the dhāraṇī through which the six perfections are retained.

Translator's Notes

• "Heart mantra" renders □□□□□□□ (Skt. hṛdaya), literally "essence" or "heart," here referring to the short mantra that distills each perfection.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.